

Currents, Articles, and Public Engagement

Guide 4 of 6

TL;DR

Currents is the firm's live commentary surface. It pulls public events in from X, decides whether the firm's corpus has anything substantive to say, and either writes a citation-grounded opinion or abstains. Every published opinion respects a set of structural invariants that prevent it from speaking outside the corpus or revealing private material. Beyond Currents proper, this guide explains the public- article dispatcher (long-form essays built from clustered opinions), the reader-response and critique-submission channels, the subscriber digest, and how to read everything the firm publishes. Operator-only actions (revocation, kill switches) are described in Guide 6.

You will need

- A signed-in Codex session, or an anonymous browser session for the public `/currents` page.
- Familiarity with how principles and conclusions work — see Guide 2.

This guide does NOT cover

- Operator-only overrides (revocation, kill switch, hold for review) — Guide 6.
- The Oracle's question-answering surface — Guide 3.

1 What Currents is

Currents is a separate origin from the main Codex. The public page is `/currents`; the founder-facing read view lives inside the Codex under `/(authed)/founder-currents`. Each “Current” is one **EventOpinion** row written by the firm in response to one outside event.

The site keeps two kinds of public artifacts in this neighborhood:

- **Currents opinions** — short, source-grounded statements attached to one specific event. They land on `/currents/<id>`.
- **Articles** — long-form essays the firm publishes after clustering enough related opinions and material. They land on `/post/<slug>` (for blog-style articles tied to an upload) or `/c/<slug>/v/<version>` (for reviewed conclusions promoted to article shape).

[screenshot screenshots/04_currents_public_feed.png not yet captured — The public `/currents` feed, with two opinions visible and one event in abstention.]

2 The pipeline, top to bottom

The Currents scheduler runs continuously, on a short cycle. Each cycle:

1. **Discovery.** The system looks for recent high-engagement public posts on X.
2. **Significance floor.** Each candidate post has a significance score computed from impressions, retweets, likes, replies, and quote-and-bookmark counts (a weighted log-sum). Posts below the configured floor are dropped.
3. **Persistence and dedupe.** Survivors become event rows.
4. **Enrichment.** The post is embedded, near-duplicate matched against recent events, and tagged with topic hints.
5. **Relevance gate.** The event's fingerprint is compared against the firm's stored conclusions and claims. The gate requires at least two qualifying hits above a relevance threshold. If the corpus can't supply them, the event becomes an *abstention* (the public page says "the firm does not have enough material to comment") and does not become an opinion.
6. **Opinion generation.** The retrieval bundle is wrapped in unambiguous markers and handed to a language model with a strict contract: the model must cite each source it leans on by id and quote verbatim spans.
7. **Citation validation.** Every quoted span in the model's output is checked against the cited source — character by character. A fabrication anywhere in the output causes the whole opinion to abstain.
8. **Strawman detection.** A separate guard checks that the opinion isn't mischaracterizing the source post.
9. **Publication.** The opinion row is written; the public `/currents` page picks it up immediately.
10. **Article dispatch.** A separate, longer-cycle job periodically scans recent opinions, clusters related ones, and — if the cluster is dense enough — drafts a long-form public article. The dispatcher is capped at a fixed number of articles per week.

3 The eight invariants

A published Currents opinion must satisfy all eight of the following structural invariants. They are enforced by the generator and the publish path; an opinion that fails any one of them is rejected before it reaches the public feed.

1. **Grounded.** Every non-trivial claim in the opinion text is backed by an inline `[C:<id>]` citation to a firm Conclusion or Principle. Free-floating assertions are not allowed.
2. **Source-respecting.** Citations resolve only to publicly-safe corpus surfaces. Private transcripts and documents may inform internal reasoning but must not appear as public citation targets.
3. **Quorum.** At least two relevance-cleared firm conclusions back the opinion. If the corpus cannot supply two, the system abstains rather than under-cite.
4. **Voice-consistent.** The opinion is written in the firm's first-person voice rather than recapping or paraphrasing the source post.
5. **Event-anchored.** Each opinion is bound to exactly one event. Multi-event commentary lives in the articles pipeline, not in Currents.
6. **Revocable.** Every opinion is publishable iff `revokedAt IS NULL`. Operator revocation is the canonical inverse of publication; there is no separate "hide" flag.

7. **Abstention-honest.** When the relevance gate fails, the system records a reason on the event and surfaces “the firm does not yet have enough material to comment.” Abstentions are a public stance.
8. **Provenance-complete.** Each opinion ships an audit trail: the source post, the relevance scores, the conclusions cited, and the generator parameters. The audit trail is addressable from the public page.

4 Reading the audit trail

Open any opinion at `/currents/<id>`. Below the body you will find:

- **Source post.** The original X post the opinion responds to. Always present, always external.
- **Cited conclusions.** A list of `[C:<id>]` references, each click-through to the firm’s Conclusion on the public site. Private conclusions never appear here.
- **Relevance scores.** The score each cited conclusion had against the source event at generation time.
- **Generator metadata.** Model identifier, prompt version, retrieval window, timestamp.
- **Revocation banner** (if revoked). The opinion is hidden from the feed but its row and audit trail remain readable for accountability.

[screenshot screenshots/04_currents_audit.png not yet captured — The audit trail block at the bottom of a Currents opinion.]

5 Follow-up Q&A on an opinion

Each opinion has a **Follow-up** thread attached. Readers (no account required) can ask a question or push back on the opinion. The firm’s responses are answered by the Oracle (Guide 3) with the same citation contract.

This is where most outside engagement happens. Readers who want their response to be formally considered for the firm’s record use the **Public response** flow instead (next section).

6 Public responses — the formal reader-engagement channel

`/responses` (public) is the form for a reader to submit a structured reply: a counter-evidence claim, a counter-argument, a clarification request, or a request to extend agreement. The form asks for the article slug, the targeted claim, and the response body.

A reader who wants their response to be *publishable by name* ticks a publish-consent box; otherwise the firm holds the response as internal feedback. The publish-consent is symmetric: even if the firm later wants to quote the reply publicly, it still needs a fresh acknowledgment on the founder’s reply.

As a founder you’ll see the resulting moderation queue on the operator side (Guide 6); for general use you can read public replies and engage in follow-up threads.

7 Critique submissions — invited expert critique

`/critiques` (public) is a higher-effort form for an invited external expert to challenge a specific published claim. Submitters provide their identity (name, email, optional ORCID, optional public URL), the article slug, the target claim, the counter-evidence, and a derivation of the alternative position.

Accepted high-severity critiques can earn a small bounty (the firm pays for being shown wrong, in public). The actual moderation and bounty confirmation is operator-only — but the public `/critiques` page lists accepted critiques with submitter credit (subject to the submitter's hall-of-fame consent).

This is one of the firm's strongest invitations to be wrong: it pays for being shown wrong, in public.

8 Subscriber digest

`/subscribe` is the public sign-up. The form is double-opt-in: the subscriber gets a confirmation email and must click through before any digest is sent. Subscribers choose their scope (firm, methodology, domain, or conclusion) and cadence (weekly, immediate, monthly).

The digest has one operational property worth knowing: *no tracking pixels*. If a subscriber wants to confirm they read a digest, they click a one-time link. Otherwise the firm has no idea who read what — on purpose.

9 Articles — long-form public essays

The article dispatcher periodically clusters recent opinions and, if a cluster is dense enough, drafts a long-form public article. Once an operator has approved the article (the gate is described in Guide 6), the article lands on `/post/<slug>` (when tied to a single upload) or `/c/<slug>/v/<version>` (when promoted from a reviewed conclusion). A published article carries:

- Its frozen body and citations, so old versions don't change when the underlying corpus shifts.
- A cryptographic signature attached to the canonical hash, written by the workshop and stored on the website. (Verifiers can recompute the hash to check the signature.)
- An optional **Addendum** chain — dated, never-edits-the- original notes that the firm appends quarterly during the methodology review week.

A reader-side feed (`/atom.xml` and `/feed.xml`) keeps an Atom and an RSS view of new articles and reviewed conclusions.

10 The founder's read of Currents

As a founder using the platform, the things you typically do with Currents are:

- Read recent opinions to develop a feel for the firm's voice.
- Open the audit trail on any opinion to see which conclusions it relied on — this is useful as a feedback loop on which of your conclusions are doing real work.
- Watch for abstentions on topics you care about. A recurring abstention is a signal that the firm should be reading more in that area.
- Engage in follow-up threads.

11 Common failure modes (what to expect)

- **No opinions in 24 hours.** Either the ingestion path is paused or the corpus is thin on relevant topics. Either way, founder-alpha sees this on the operations card before you do.
- **Opinions look like they are recapping rather than opining.** The generator falls back to thinner prose when its retrieval comes back near-empty. Solve it by adding firm material on the topic.

- **An opinion seems to misread the source.** The strawman-detection guard catches most of these but not all. Use the **Critiques** form to flag it.

12 Where the docs are

- The other five guides in this series.
- Guide 6 covers the operator surfaces for Currents (revocation, kill switch, hold for review).

Where to read next

Continue with [Guide 5 — Forecasts and Portfolio](#) for the prediction-market surface, which shares Currents' grounding principles but adds a much stricter operator confirmation flow before any real-money order can be placed.